

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Braja Nayak

Address: 32 Autumn Drive Sutton SM2 5BA

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Subject: Objection to Planning Application DM2025/01591 - Change of Use to Place of Worship and Community Hub, Former Ambulance Station, Dorset Road, Belmont (SM2 6HX)

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to formally object to planning application DM2025/01591, which proposes the change of use of the former ambulance station on Dorset Road, Belmont, to a mixed-use place of worship and community hub.

As a resident living in close proximity to the site, I have significant concerns regarding the impact of this development on highway safety, parking, residential amenity, and the overall character of the area.

1. Highway Safety, Traffic Impact, and School Proximity

The site is located very close to Avenue Primary School, where traffic congestion is already severe during school drop-off and pick-up times. The proposed development is likely to generate substantial additional vehicle movements that would coincide with peak school hours, significantly increasing risks to children, parents, and pedestrians.

The surrounding roads are residential and constrained, with limited turning space and visibility. Increased congestion and unsafe manoeuvres could compromise road safety and hinder access for emergency vehicles.

2. Inadequate Parking Provision

The proposal appears to provide limited on-site parking relative to anticipated attendance levels. This is likely to result in overspill parking on nearby residential streets, particularly during school hours, exacerbating existing parking pressures and creating hazardous conditions.

Blocked driveways, reduced visibility at junctions, and restricted access for refuse collection and emergency services would have a serious impact on residents and the safe operation of the area.

3. Impact on Residential Amenity

The scale and intensity of use associated with a place of worship and community hub could result in increased noise, disturbance, and general activity, particularly during early mornings, evenings, weekends, and special events. This would detract from the quiet enjoyment of neighbouring homes.

Increased footfall and vehicle movements may also affect privacy and the overall sense of safety within the neighbourhood.

4. Overdevelopment and Character of the Area

The proposed use represents a significant intensification compared to the previous use of the site. The level of activity generated would be out of keeping with the predominantly residential character of Dorset Road and surrounding streets.

5. Reliance on Management Measures

The application appears to rely heavily on operational management measures (such as attendance control and parking management) rather than providing sufficient physical infrastructure to mitigate impacts. Such measures may be difficult to enforce consistently over time.

Conclusion

While I recognise the importance of community facilities, I believe that this proposal, in its current form, would result in unacceptable harm to highway safety-particularly given its proximity to Avenue Primary School-parking conditions, residential amenity, and the character of the local area.

I respectfully request that the Council refuse planning application DM2025/01591, or require substantial revisions to address the concerns outlined above.

Yours faithfully,
Braja Nayak